

Observation Sheet

A field record for one pixel or plot. Fill in after each visit, significant weather event, or care action. The eight categories are a practical land-based starter grammar, not universal indicators. Adapt them to place and local knowledge.

Place / pixel / privacy code: _____ Date: _____

Weather: _____ Observer: _____

Use this sheet after each visit, planting, pruning, rain event, or change you notice. Mark N/A where a category does not fit; name uncertainty rather than forcing an answer.

Decisive question: Is this practice giving to life?

1 Soil cover

Is the surface covered or bare?

☐ Covered ☐ Partial ☐ Bare

2 Vegetation layering

Are multiple layers present?

☐ Layered ☐ Partial ☐ Flat / mono

3 Water behaviour

Does water infiltrate or run off?

☐ Absorbs ☐ Mixed ☐ Runs off

4 Succession signals

Is the system becoming more complex?

☐ Advancing ☐ Holding ☐ Resetting

5 Biodiversity presence

What species are present — plants, insects, birds?

☐ Diverse ☐ Some ☐ Absent

6 Soil health signals

Smell, texture, earthworms, fungal signs?

☐ Alive ☐ Mixed ☐ Flat / hard

7 Biomass cycle

Is organic matter returned or removed?

☐ Returned ☐ Partial ☐ Removed

8 Human rhythm

Is the work rhythm sustainable for the people doing it?

☐ Sustainable ☐ Strained ☐ Depleted

NOTES Actions, local knowledge, uncertainty, and what to carry forward

Actions since last visit / locally chosen observation

What the place seems to need next / uncertainty:
noticed · inferred · known

What changed or surprised you / local knowledge note

N/A categories and why / sketch or photo reference

Remember: An honest gap or uncertainty is more valuable than a fabricated green.

Local knowledge is shared only with consent. This sheet feeds the PG Ledger — keep it, date it, file it.

Is this practice giving to life?